FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-23-18001

Issue Title : 737 Recorder Independent Power Supply (RIPS) Obsolescence

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2371-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
03/03/2018	01/29/2019	05/30/2018

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Revision Description

The delivery date of L/N 6998 was shifted to June.

The mention of a service letter was removed.

A service letter will not be released since we certified the NiCd RIPS in production making it applicable to any plane in service.

The IPC will reflect the new part number.

Applicability

The NiCd RIPS was incorporated in production from airplane L/N 6998 and on.
In service airplanes will be updated when the Li-ion RIPS supply is depleted.

Description

The existing Lithium Ion (Li-ion) RIPS will be replaced by Nickel Cadmium (NiCd) RIPS that fits into the existing mounting and connector interfaces. This change applies to all 737NG and 737MAX airplanes with the RIPS containing Li-ion batteries, both in production and retrofit. The two parts are two-way interchangeable.

Background

The Recorder Independent Power Supply (RIPS) provides 10 minutes of backup power to the 737 Cockpit Voice Recorder (CVR). This capability is required for airplane dispatch.
The Li-ion RIPS, which includes eight rechargeable Li-ion batteries, has a part obsolescence issue which affects the Lithium Protection Circuit Printed Wire Assembly (PWA) within the Commercial Off-the-Shelf (COTS) Rechargeable Lithium Ion Battery Cell assembly.
A redesign of this secondary protection circuit with an updated component would be necessary to support continued production of this unit. Since the obsolescence issue affects the Lithium battery design, current FAA special conditions must be applied to any battery design revision to the RIPS.
Instead of pursuing re-certification of the Li-ion RIPS, Boeing certified an existing NiCd RIPS.

The NiCd RIPS has been in service since 2010 and currently more than 2500 units are in service.
The NiCd RIPS and Li-ion RIPS are two-way interchangeable.

Status

The NiCd RIPS has been certified in production.

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Interim Action

Li-ion RIPS will still be acceptable for use, thus no interim operator actions have been identified.

Final Action

The NiCd RIPS was incorporated in production from L/N 6998 and on.

Airplane L/N 6998 was delivered on June 29, 2018.
For spares, continue using RIPS with Li-ion batteries until supply depletes.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

L/N 6998 Delivered: June 29, 2018

Part Information

Due to obsolescence, Li-ion RIPS part number 100-3020-400 will be replaced with NiCd RIPS part number 100-3010-401.

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
RIPS w/ NiCd Batteries		Radiant	100-3010-401

Related Categories

- New Equipment : Information on new parts available now or soon to be introduced
- Obsolescence : Information on parts that are obsolete, becoming obsolete, or have excessive lead times

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